



FREE PORT GUIDE · BEACHCOMBER · GALVESTON

Margaritaville at Sea Beachcomber from the Port of Galveston

Texas, it's your turn! Beachcomber arrives in Galveston in October 2027 with weekly 4- to 7-night sailings to Mexico, the Western Caribbean, the Bahamas and even the ABC islands.

SHIP

Margaritaville at Sea Beachcomber

TERMINAL

Cruise Terminal 28

CRUISE LENGTHS

4 to 7 nights (plus a 9-night repositioning from Miami)

HOMEPORT

Port of Galveston, Galveston, TX

SERVICE BEGINS

October 2027 · weekly departures

NEAREST AIRPORTS

Houston Hobby (HOU), about 1 hr · Bush (IAH), about 1.5 hrs

Meet Beachcomber

Margaritaville at Sea's new flagship (formerly Costa Fortuna) carries about 2,700 guests at double occupancy and features more than 15 new experiences, including **Same Boat**, a live-music venue created with Zac Brown. Fan favorites like 5 o'Clock Somewhere, Cheeseburger in Paradise, License to Chill and the Hemisphere Dancer are on board too. Margaritaville at Sea is the seventh cruise line to sail from Galveston.

Getting to the port

Flying in

- **Houston Hobby (HOU)** is the closer airport at about 50 miles, roughly an hour.
- **George Bush Intercontinental (IAH)** is about 70+ miles, roughly 1.5 hours or more with traffic.
- Galveston has no commercial airport, so book a shuttle or rental car, or plan a rideshare.
- Fly in the day before. I-45 traffic can be unpredictable.

Driving in

- Take I-45 South over the Galveston Causeway, then follow Harborside Drive to the cruise terminals.
- Galveston often hosts several ships on the same day, so arrive early and follow port signs for **Terminal 28**.
- Drop bags with porters before parking.

Parking

Option	Typical cost (7-night cruise)	Good to know
Port of Galveston lots	About \$150–\$225 total	Price depends on the lot and terminal. Reserve online in advance for the best rate.
Independent lots	About \$125–\$220 total	Many include shuttles; some are walkable. Check reviews and look for coupons.
Park-and-cruise hotels	Varies	Stay the night before and park free or discounted.

Chill tip: Parking in Galveston can cost as much as Miami, so book early. Port parking for Terminal 28 will be confirmed closer to launch.

Embarkation day, the easy way

- Expect an assigned arrival window about 3 weeks before sailing (suites and Priority guests board first).
- Print luggage tags from Cruise Control and attach them at home.
- Your final check-in cutoff will be on your boarding pass. Treat it as a hard deadline.

Before you sail: stay & play in Galveston

- **The Strand Historic District** for Victorian architecture, shops and fudge.
- **Pier 21** on the harbor for seafood and a front-row ship view.
- **Galveston Island Historic Pleasure Pier** on the Seawall for rides and Gulf views.
- **Moody Gardens** pyramids and the Seawall's 10-mile beachfront.

Where Beachcomber sails from Galveston

Sailing	Ports of call
4-night Cozumel Express	Cozumel
7-night Mexico	Cozumel + Progreso
7-night Western Caribbean	Mix of Jamaica, Belize, Grand Cayman, Cozumel, Key West + Roatán
7-night Bahamas	Nassau + Bimini
Other sailings	Aruba, Curaçao, Grand Bahama Island, Montego Bay + Veracruz (Mexico)
9-night repositioning (fall 2027)	Miami to Galveston

Exact port combinations vary by date. Ask us for the sailing calendar.

Port-of-call cheat sheet

Cozumel & Progreso, Mexico

Cozumel offers reefs and beach clubs. Progreso is your door to Maya ruins and Mérida.

Grand Cayman & Jamaica

Stingray City and Seven Mile Beach in Grand Cayman; Montego Bay's beaches and river rafting in Jamaica.

Veracruz, Mexico

A rare cruise call! Historic port city with seafood, the fortress of San Juan de Ulúa and the lively zócalo.

Roatán & Belize

Snorkel West Bay in Roatán. In Belize, go cave tubing or reef snorkeling (tender port).

Key West

Duval Street, bike rides and the Mallory Square sunset.

Aruba & Curaçao

Powdery Eagle Beach in Aruba and Willemstad's candy-colored waterfront in Curaçao.

Nassau, Bimini & Grand Bahama

Classic Bahamas: turquoise water, conch fritters and beach days.



Margaritaville at Sea need-to-knows

- **Gratuities** are added automatically: \$22 per person, per night in staterooms; \$25 in suites.
- **Drinking age is 21** for all alcoholic beverages.
- **No outside alcohol.** Bottles bought in port are held at the gangway and returned at the end of the cruise.
- **The booking guest must be 18+.** Minors sailing without a parent need a Parental/Legal Guardian Release Form.
- **Names must match.** The name on your ID has to match your reservation exactly.
- **Original documents only.** Photocopies and phone photos of IDs are not accepted.



Embarkation-day carry-on checklist

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| ☐ Passport or birth certificate + government photo ID (originals!) | ☐ Medications and anything you can't live without |
| ☐ Printed or digital boarding pass for every guest | ☐ Phone charger & a small power bank |
| ☐ Credit card for your onboard account | ☐ Reusable water bottle |
| ☐ Luggage tags printed and attached at home | ☐ Parking confirmation or pickup details |
| ☐ Swimsuit, sunscreen & sunglasses (cabins may not be ready right away) | ☐ Flip-flops and a cover-up for pool time |

Want us to handle the details?

Our travel advisors love Margaritaville at Sea and can help you pick the right sailing and cabin, line up pre-cruise hotels and transfers, and watch for price drops, at no extra cost to you. Galveston sailings are already open for booking, so grab the best cabins early.

👉 **Plan My Cruise at cruisestoursandtravel.com** · Share your own cruise story: admin@margaritavilleatseablog.com

Information current as of October 2026 and gathered from Margaritaville at Sea, port authorities and cruise news sources. Ports, terminals, times, fees and itineraries change, so please confirm with the cruise line, the port and your boarding pass before you go. Drive and distance figures are approximate. The Chill Compass is an independent blog and is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by Margaritaville at Sea or Margaritaville Enterprises. All trademarks belong to their respective owners. Presented by Cruises Tours and Travel, LLC · Florida Seller of Travel Reg. No. ST150140.